English Communication & Engineering Career Skills (ECECS)

UESTC2029 / UESTCHN2005

Lecture 7: Interview & Job Skills (1)

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Lecture 7 Aims

- learn how to make a good first impression in an interview
- consider different types of interviews
- develop awareness of how to manage interviews successfully

Task 1.1 Think and share

- How long does it take for an interviewer to decide if a person is suitable for a job?
- Make a list of Dos and Don’ts for interviews

  E.g. Be prepared, Don’t be late …

Task 1.2: *Making a good first impression*

First impressions: Video

Applicant name	Yes	No	Why/Why not
Anthony	x		Blah blah blah
Marissa		x	
Christa			
Todd			
Kaitlin			
Steven			

30 Seconds to Impress

Watch later

Share

0:00 / 6:52

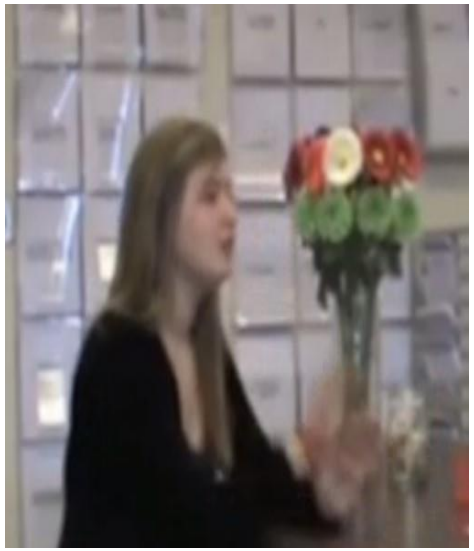
YouTube

Who would you hire?

First impressions

Anthony

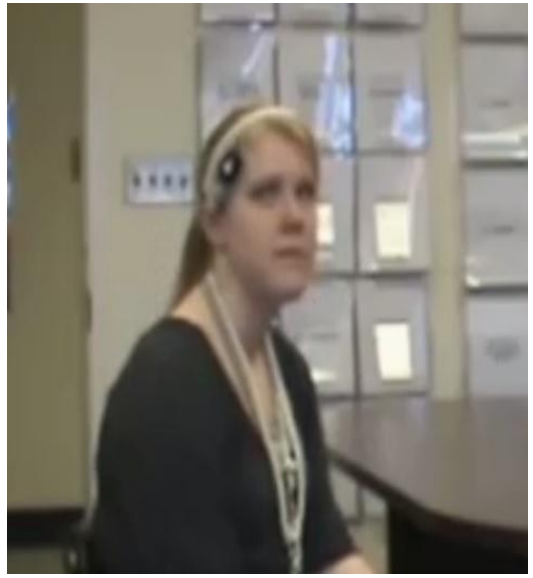
- Arrives late
- Gives his portfolio to fix his tie! (Awkward!)
- Interrupts interviewer to ask about salary and vacation!



Marissa

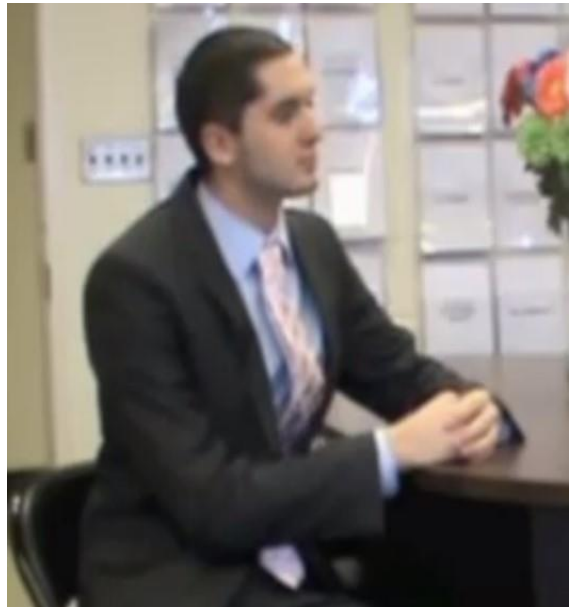
- Very enthusiastic + friendly
- Maybe a little ‘over the top’
- Interrupts interviewer to say she has a lot of things not on her resume
- Hasn’t brought updated one
- Unprofessional

First impressions



Christa

- Strange from beginning
- Asks who she is, she answers ‘good’
- Not listening.
- Looks around room, no eye contact
- Jewellery distracting



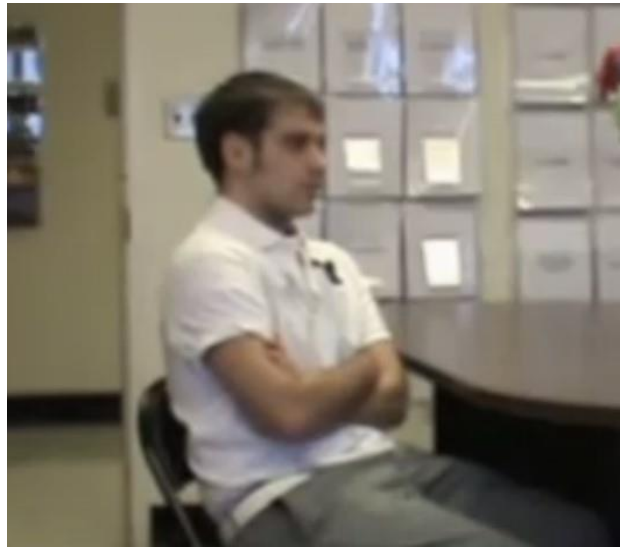
Todd

- Dressed professionally; firm handshake
- Asks if received resume
- Makes eye contact, nodding, and listening

First impressions

Kaitlin

- Arrives on phone, drinking coffee
- Outfit cute, but not formal
- Puts huge bag on the table
- Hunched over posture, sipping coffee
- Too comfortable, too relaxed!



Steven

- Doesn’t knock, shy
- Clothes not professional, hands in pockets
- Soft handshake
- Crosses his arms, shakes legs
- Very nervous

Interview Dos + Don’ts

Arrive early

Dress professionally

Give a firm handshake

Be confident

Make eye contact

Listen

Don’t interrupt

SMILE

So what is an interview?

Look at the word!

- Inter-view (entre voir)
- ‘to see each other’
- to *get to know* each other
- A conversation between (two) people
- Asking questions to obtain information about each other
- remember – **the employer** is interviewing **you**, but **you** are also interviewing **the employer**

Task 1.3 Making conversation

- Who will you have a conversation with during the Group Interview?

- What will the conversation be about?

Task 1.3 Making conversation – it’s a 2-way street

You will talk to the interviewer about

Your CV and cover letter

EDI

Your experience

You will ask the interviewer a question about the post

You will talk to the other interviewee about

your project

You will ask the other interviewee about

their project

Types of Interviews

Types of Interviews

Is there only one type of interview?

- Face to face interview
- Telephone interview
- Video interview
- Panel interview
- MMI: Multiple mini-interview
- **Group interview**

3. Managing an interview successfully: Dealing with questions

How can I prepare for ALL the questions?

- Look through your CV
- Read the job description
- Review typical interview questions
  - Tell me about yourself.
  - What are your strengths; your weaknesses?
  - Why should we hire you?
  - Why do you want to work in this company?
  - Where do you want to be in 5 years?

Practise OUT LOUD but don't script!

Types of Questions in our interview?

- about your Portfolio
- about your experience (competence based + scenario based)
- about EDI
- about your Project

Practise OUT LOUD but don't script!
Practise with a partner.

3. Managing an interview successfully: How to be confident in an interview

Practise questions out loud!

Prepare ahead of time

Power pose!

How to be confident in an interview

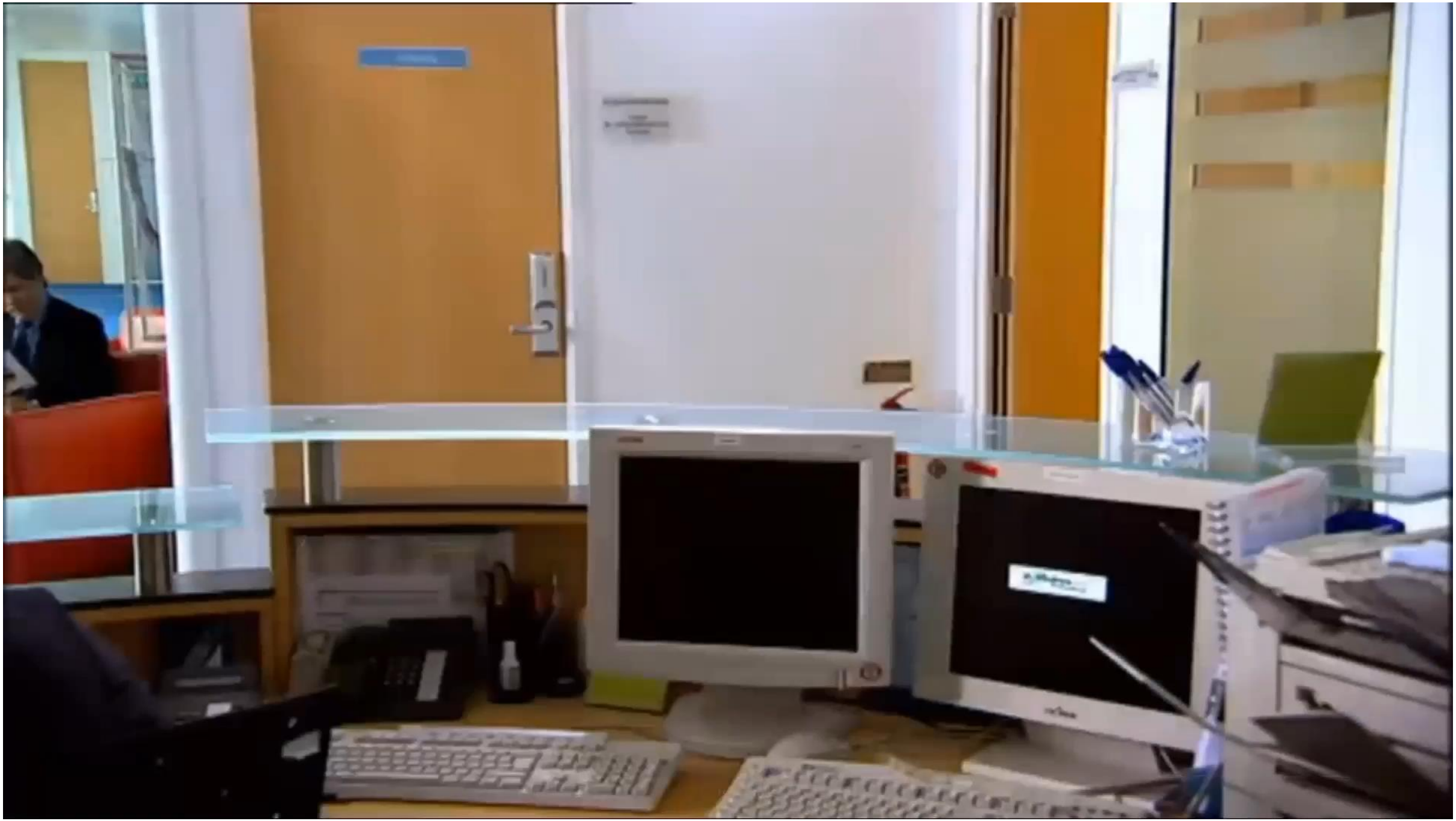
- Practise “auditioning” to others
- Low energy – high energy music
- High anxiety – meditation
- Body language: posture, eye contact, lean forward
- Eating and drinking

Lecture 8 Aims

- Develop approaches to manage an interview successfully
- Work on answering questions to land the job
- Take part in a Q+A

Should I exaggerate?

I can do that!



Task 1.2 More advice

Watch the clip from the Harvard Business Review

1. What useful advice does she give about interviews?

2. Is there any information which might be bad advice, or which **conflicts** with other information you have heard?

Harvard
Business
Review

Task 1.2 Feedback

Harvard Business Review

Amy Gallo

1. What useful advice does she give about interviews?
   - Do your homework – about the job, and about yourself
   - Tell impactful stories – (remember the STAR technique (CS5))
   - Stories can be about mistakes – not just perfect moments
   - Be well prepared (but see below!)

2. Is there any information which might be bad advice, or which **conflicts** with other information you have heard?
   - Telling an employer about a time “you saved the organisation” may be an exaggeration!
   - Practice is good – but actors **memorise** what they say. **Don’t** try to memorise everything (be flexible)
   - First impressions are made in the first 30 seconds? Or 15? What is it?

Task 1.3 Asking questions at the end of an interview

Remember you are also interviewing the company!

Questions **not** to ask:

- Do not ask about salary or benefits (though may want to know about arrangements for an internship)
- Also, don't just say '*No, it's fine. No questions*'.

Good questions should show an interest in the role:

- success-related
- culture-related
- connecting (interpersonal)

You will practise these in CS12

Success focus

- What were some of the biggest challenges for the last person who did this job?
- In 3 months, how will you know you hired the right person?
- What would you like someone to accomplish during the internship?
- What have past interns done to be successful in this position?
- How is performance measured and reviewed?
- What are some of the challenges you believe there are for an intern here?

Culture focus

- What is a typical week like for an intern here?
- What makes this company a good place for an intern to work in?
- How are interns given support during their internship?
- What can I learn from the other people in this company?
- How would you describe the work culture here?
- What values are important to this company?
- What type of professional development will I be offered?

Connecting focus

- What made you choose to work in this company?
- What is the best thing about working here?
- What makes this company a good place to work in?
- Can you tell me about the team I'll be working with?
- What would you recommend about working here?
- What will I gain from working with your team?

Using indirect questions

- How would you describe the work culture here?
- **I'd really like to know/to find out/to learn more about...**
- ***I'd really like to know how you would describe the work culture here.***
- What values are important to this company?
- **I'm really interested in...**
- ***I'm really interested in what values are important to this company.***

Using indirect questions

- *I wonder if you could tell me*
- *Would you be able to give me more information about...*
- *I'd really like to know/to find out/to learn more about...*
- *I'm really interested in...*

Task 1.4 10 things not to say/do in an interview

1. *‘So, what would I be doing in this job?’*
2. *‘I can handle any situation.’*
3. *‘How much will I be paid?’*
4. Talking negatively about previous job/course.
5. Don’t be cocky (arrogant)
6. Do not show you are desperate for the job.
7. Don’t blame your answers on nerves.
8. Don’t talk about being recommended by someone.
9. Don’t say you are not interested in subject/company.
10. Don’t talk about competitors.

Task 1.5 before a job interview

Remember **CAR & STAR …**

And now…

TODAY

Teamwork

Overcoming Obstacles

Duties of your past positions

Achievements

Your strengths and weaknesses

Out-of-class work

Homework:

- Review your notes and the PPT slides
- Work on asking and answering questions

Extra work:

- Post a message in the Lecture Forum telling us what your ‘power song’ would be (a link to it would also be great!)
- Watch this Ted Video https://www.ted.com/talks/amy_cuddy_your_body_language_may_shape_who_you_are